Yonghoon Kwon

Research Intern

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Profile

I began my career as an ML Researcher at Glorang at the age of 20 and later worked at Selectstar. I am now a Research Intern at Yonsei University's MLAI Lab, studying self-evolving systems. I explore "Expansion", a framework in which AI models learn to redefine and restructure their own task specifications through real-world interactions.

Research Interests

Small language models and efficient reasoning; open-ended self-evolving LLMs; meta-learning architectures; adaptive evaluation.

Publications

- **Yonghoon Kwon**†, Hoyoon Byun†, Kyungwoo Song. "R_Q-Evolve: LLMs Evolve Their Own Generator Programs for Self-Improvement." *NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Continual Learning in the Era of Foundation Models and Embodied Agents.*
- **Yonghoon Kwon**†, Heondeuk Lee†, Barom Kang. "E-star 12B: Reliable Rubric-Following and Domain-Adaptive SLM Evaluator for Korean Industrial Settings." *ACL 2026 Workshop on Generation, Evaluation and Metrics (GEM).* Paper.
- Sunguk Choi†, **Yonghoon Kwon**†, Heondeuk Lee†. "CAC-CoT: Connector-Aware Compact Chain-of-Thought for Efficient Reasoning Data Synthesis Across Dual-System Cognitive Tasks." *EMNLP 2025 Findings.* Paper.
- Sunguk Choi†, **Yonghoon Kwon**†, Dongjin Seo. "Context- and Alignment-Based Speech–Text Fusion Model for Sentiment Analysis." *Proceedings of KCC 2023* (Korean Computer Science Conference).

† Co-first authors.

Work Experience

Yonsei University, Seoul, South Korea *May 2026 – Present*
Research Intern, MLAI

- Conducting research on self-improving language models for mathematical reasoning.

Selectstar, Seoul, South Korea *Jan 2025 – Apr 2026*
AI Research Engineer (Full-time)

- Developed a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) pipeline evaluation model for the financial domain, incorporating long-context understanding, domain-specific training and Reason & Score-based assessment; achieved the best performance among internal and open-source baselines.
- Constructed an instruction dataset of 10,000 algorithmic and software engineering prompts for SKT's proprietary foundation model.

Glorang, Seoul, South Korea *Dec 2022 – May 2024*
ML Research Engineer (Full-time)

- Proposed and designed novel methodologies in the EduAI domain to enhance learner feedback and personalisation.

Skills & Certifications

- **Programming & Tools:** Python, Transformers, PyTorch, DeepSpeed, Git, Docker, Chalice
- **Certifications:** Google Machine Learning Bootcamp (Cohort 3, Jun 2022); ADSP Big Data Analyst

Awards & Honors

- Bronze Medal, *4th Korean Emotion Recognition Competition*, Chonnam National University (Oct 2022)
- 3rd Place, *AI Grand Challenge – Open Track*, AGC (Aug 2023)
- Stage 2 Winner (Policy Support AI), *AI Grand Challenge*, IITP Director's Award, AGC (Nov 2023)

Patents

- "Question generation method and server for human performance test using a question–answer network based on a language model." Application No. 10-2023-0088846.
- "Sampling process for personality tests using a BERT question–answer network representing the respondent population." Application No. 10-2023-0049090.